

Marwadi (Marwari), Step by Step, Sign by Sign

A gentle writing-first curriculum, one usable greeting at a time

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Starter edition — twenty-two lessons, each no longer than five minutes.

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How to use this starter edition

Begin with no assumed Marwadi and no assumed Devanagari. Each section lasts at most five minutes. The first section gives the hand one sign to copy; later sections move through guided copy, delayed copy, and independent recall. The writing ramp never waits for an alphabet chapter and never asks for a sign that has not already been isolated.

The name in the title is deliberately double. Official and linguistic sources often use *Marwari*; many speakers and learners use *Marwadi*. This book uses Marwadi as its short name and keeps Marwari visible for discoverability.

Chapter 1 makes one narrow promise: you will be able to read, say, and write the respectful greeting राम-राम सा, and answer it. Chapter 2 adds one formal gratitude response, आभार, through two new signs. Chapter 3 isolates two more signs before adding respectful affirmative हां सा. Chapter 4 first teaches *pāṇī*, “water,” by ear, then isolates each new sign before the learner reads and writes पाणी. Chapter 5 builds the name answer म्हारो नाम राम है; Chapter 6 adds the question थारो नाम काँई है?. These are real pre-A1 steps, not a claim that the level is complete.

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Chapter 1

Ram-Ram Sa: A Greeting the Hand Can Make

Modes:  voice (2)  pen (5)  Hands-free start: none of the 7 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can recognise, read, say, copy, and write the respectful Marwadi greeting राम-राम सा, and answer it with the same greeting.

A two-line authentic greeting exchange followed by independent written recall, using only signs and language taught in the chapter.

1.1 र — one sign, and the beginning of a greeting

You do not need an alphabet first. Today your eye and hand need one sign.

Script — notice the sign

र — *ra*

Devanagari consonants carry a short *a* by default, so this is **ra**, not a bare *r*. The *r* is a quick tongue-tip tap.

Writing — guided copy

Put a finger over र and follow the printed shape. Then copy it three times, large and slow. Say *ra* each time your pen stops.

This lesson asks you to copy the shape you can see. It does not invent one universal stroke order where school traditions differ.

Before you move on

Cover the model. Point to the one you copied most clearly and say its sound.

1.2 ा — make *ra* into *rā*

Read र. (*ra*.) Copy it once.

Script — add one mark

The mark ा sits on the right of a consonant and lengthens its vowel:

र *ra* + ा *ā* = रा *rā*

Hold *ā* steady; do not turn it into English *ray*.

Writing — guided copy

- copy र
- add ा on its right
- read the result: रा *rā*

Do that three times. On the last copy, wait five seconds after looking at the model before you write.

Before you move on

Which is *ra*: र or रा? Which is *rā*?

1.3 म — your first whole written word

Write रा after looking away from the model. Check it, then begin.

Script — add म

म — *ma*

Join it to the piece you know:

रा $rā$ + म ma = राम $rām$

At the end of this word, the built-in vowel of म is not pronounced in ordinary speech. Read the whole word $rām$. राम is the name *Ram*. The Marwadi greeting you are building will repeat this name. Today you only need the one word राम; the complete greeting still comes later.

Writing — from copy to memory

1. copy म twice
2. copy राम once while looking
3. hide the model for ten seconds
4. write राम from memory, then compare

If the memory copy stalls, return only to the missing sign.

Before you move on

Read राम without using the romanization, say that it is the name *Ram*, then write it once more.

1.4 स — a second consonant

Read राम, say what it means, then write it from memory. Check that your last sign is म.

Script — notice and copy

स — sa

Like र, this consonant carries a short a . Do not confuse the two:

र ra · स sa

Finger-trace स, then copy it three times. Say sa as each copy finishes.

Before you move on

Cover the large model and write स once from the copy you remember.

1.5 सा — reuse a mark instead of learning a new rule

What did ा do to र? Apply the same change to स.

Script — assemble

स *sa* + ा *ā* = सा *sā*

The writing rule is old; only the combination is new. In the greeting you are building, सा is a respectful form of address.

Writing — delayed copy

Copy सा once. Look away for ten seconds, say *sā*, and write it again. Then retrieve the two known pieces separately rather than using them as a phrase before the next lesson teaches the greeting:

राम

>

सा

Before you move on

Read राम, then सा. Circle the copy of ा in each separate word.

1.6 राम-राम सा — your first complete Marwadi greeting

Read राम and सा separately. You already own every sign in to-day's line.

The exchange — meet the greeting

राम-राम सा। — *Rām-rām sā*. — a respectful greeting

Repeat राम, then add respectful सा. Rajasthan Sahitya Akademi's *Jāgtī Jot* prints this exchange:

A: राम-राम सा।

>

B: राम-राम सा, राम-राम।

That attestation is why this track begins here rather than substituting a Hindi greeting merely because the scripts are shared.

Your turn — use and write it

- *Hear:* *rām-rām sā* [YOU ANSWER: राम-राम सा]
- *Read it:* राम-राम सा [YOU SAY: the line without romanization]
- *Copy:* राम-राम सा once, keeping the hyphen and space

Before you move on

Hide the line. Say the greeting once; then write as much as you can remember.

Source: Rajasthan Sahitya Akademi, *Jāgtī Jot*, August–September 2018.

1.7 Practice — hear it, answer it, write it

With the page covered, write राम and सा separately. Check only after both are down.

The exchange

A: राम-राम सा।

>

B: राम-राम सा, राम-राम।

Run both voices once. Then cover B and answer A aloud. Switch roles.

Your turn — four-skill checkpoint

1. **Listen:** ask someone or a screen reader to say *rām-rām sā* without showing the text; identify it as a greeting. 2. **Speak:** give the greeting without reading. 3. **Read:** read राम-राम सा without romanization. 4. **Write:** close the book for fifteen seconds, then write राम-राम सा from memory. Check the repeated word, hyphen, space, and final सा.

Writing counts only if the model was hidden. Copying was the ramp; this is recall.

Before you move on

If one sign stalled, mark that sign and repeat only its short lesson tomorrow.

Chapter 2

Aabhaar: Formal Thanks, Two New Signs

Modes:  voice (1)  pen (3)  Hands-free start: none of the 4 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can recognise, hear, say, copy, and independently write आभार as a short formal gratitude response.

A source-attested formal gratitude word built from two new signs and two signs already taught, followed by independent four-skill retrieval.

2.1 आ — long ā at the beginning

With the page covered, write राम and give the greeting reply you learnt in Chapter 1. Uncover. Point to the vowel mark in रा: you know ी when long ā follows a consonant.

Script — one new sign

When long ā begins a word, it stands by itself:

आ — ā

Notice the upright line at the right. Say one steady ā while your finger follows the sign.

Writing — observe, trace, copy

1. look at आ for three seconds
2. finger-trace it once
3. copy it twice
4. compare only the upright line and the top bar

Do not add a word yet. This session belongs to one sign.

Before you move on

Cover the models. Write आ once, then uncover and compare.

2.2 भ — *bha*, with a small breath

Write स, then आ, from memory. Check both before moving on.

Script — one new sign and sound

भ — *bha*

Begin like English *b*, then let a small puff of air follow. Hold a hand near your mouth: *bha*. The breath is part of the sound.

Writing — observe, trace, copy

1. look at भ
2. finger-trace its lower shape, then the upright line
3. copy भ twice
4. say *bha* after each copy

Stop there. The next lesson will join this sign to signs already in your hand.

Before you move on

Cover the model for five seconds. Write भ, uncover, and compare.

2.3 आभार — formal thanks, built from known signs

Write सा from memory. Then read these four pieces: आ • भ • ा • र.

Script — build the word

Join only signs you already know:

आ + भ + ा + र = आभार

>

ābhār — formal thanks; gratitude

Rajasthan Sahitya Akademi's *Jāgtī Jot* uses आभार when expressing gratitude in Rajasthani prose. It is a formal, Sanskrit-derived word. This lesson keeps that register visible rather than pretending every kind of thanks sounds the same.

Writing — from guided to delayed copy

1. copy आभार once while looking
2. point to भा and say *bhā*
3. hide the word for ten seconds
4. write आभार from memory
5. compare one sign at a time

If one sign stalls, practise only that sign before trying the word again.

Before you move on

Read आभार, say its meaning, then write it once with the model covered.

Source: Rajasthan Sahitya Akademi, *Jāgtī Jot*, April 2004.

2.4 Practice — receive a kindness, offer formal thanks

Give the respectful Chapter 1 greeting from memory. Then, with the new word covered, write आ, then भ. Uncover and check.

The exchange — one courtesy move

Someone helps you or gives you something. Offer formal thanks:

आभार। — *Ābhār*. — Thank you. / My gratitude.

Use it here as a complete short response. A later chapter can add a more casual Marwadi gratitude form; do not make this one word carry every register.

Your turn — four tiny skills

1. **Listen:** ask someone or a screen reader to say *ābhār*; identify it as formal gratitude.
2. **Speak:** imagine receiving help and say आभार without reading.
3. **Read:** choose the thanks word from राम · आभार · सा.
4. **Write:** close the book for fifteen seconds, then write आभार from memory.

The written response counts only with the model hidden.

Before you move on

If आ or भ stalled, return to that sign's two-minute practice before repeating the whole word.

Chapter 3

Haan Sa: A Respectful Yes, Sign by Sign

Modes: ⇄ voice (2) ✍ pen (3) ⇄ Hands-free start: none of the 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can recognise, hear, say, copy, and independently write हाँ सा as a respectful affirmative answer.

A source-attested polite affirmative built from two tiny script steps and the already-known respect word सा, followed by independently scored four-skill retrieval.

3.1 ह — *ha*, one new sign

Give the Chapter 1 greeting reply from memory. Then, with आभार covered, say it as formal thanks and write it once. Uncover only long enough to check each sign.

Script — one sign and one sound

ह — *ha*

Let the air pass freely as you say *ha*. Do not add the rest of the coming word yet; today the eye, ear, voice, and hand meet only ह.

Writing — observe, trace, copy

1. look at ह for three seconds
2. finger-trace its lower curve and upright line
3. copy ह twice
4. say *ha* after each copy

Before you move on

Cover the model for five seconds. Write ह, uncover, and compare.

3.2 ः — a small dot for the nasal ending

Write ह, then भ, from memory. Add the familiar long-ā mark to ह: हा. Read it once.

Script — one small new mark

ँ — a dot above

In the source spelling हँ, this dot cues the nasal ending. Say *hā(n)* slowly: the vowel is long and the ending resonates through the nose. Speakers vary, so listen for the whole word rather than forcing one exaggerated sound.

Writing — add only the mark

1. copy हा once 2. look at हँ 3. add ँ above the end of your copy 4. compare the dot's position, then say *hā(n)*

Before you move on

Hide हँ for five seconds. Write it once, then uncover and compare.

3.3 हां सा — a respectful yes

Say the Chapter 1 greeting from memory. Write हां, then सा, as two separate known pieces.

The exchange — join the two pieces

हां सा। — *Hā(n) sā.* — Yes, respectfully.

The first word answers yes. Familiar सा keeps the answer respectful. A scholarly Marwari text edition identifies *hā(n)-sā* as the polite affirmative, and a Rajasthan Sahitya Akademi dialogue writes हां सा in context.

Writing — guided, then delayed

1. copy हां सा once while looking
2. point to the space between the answer and the respect word
3. hide the phrase for ten seconds
4. write हां सा from memory
5. compare हां, the space, and सा separately

Before you move on

Say हां सा once without looking, then write it once with the model covered.

Sources: Hess, *Texts and Translations* and Rajasthan Sahitya Akademi, *Jāgtī Jot*, April–May 2019.

3.4 Listen and answer — yes without the page

Write the first sign of आभार, then the first sign of हां सा. Say which belongs to formal thanks and which begins a yes answer.

You'll want to know: answer by ear

Have someone or a screen reader say these in either order: *ābhār* and *hā(n)sā*. Without looking, point left for formal thanks and right for respectful yes. Then say हां सा as the answer to a question you accept.

Your turn — four tiny skills

1. **Listen:** identify *hā(n)sā* without seeing it.
2. **Speak:** answer yes respectfully without reading.
3. **Read:** choose हां सा from आभार · हां सा · राम.
4. **Write:** cover all models and write only हां.

Before you move on

Close the page. Say हां सा, then write हां from memory.

3.5 Practice — hear a yes, give a yes

With the page covered, write भ, then हां. Say आभार for formal thanks; say हां सा for a respectful yes.

Your turn — independent four-skill check

1. **Listen:** hear $hā(n) sā$ and identify an affirmative answer, without text.
2. **Speak:** hear “Will you come?” and answer yes respectfully, without notes.
3. **Read:** cover the English and explain हँ सा.
4. **Write:** hear $hā(n) sā$, wait fifteen seconds, then write the complete phrase.

Score each line separately. A missed line is the one to repeat; three stronger skills do not erase a writing or listening miss.

What you’ve built — and what remains

You can now give one respectful affirmative. You have not yet learnt the Marwadi responses for no or okay, and you have not completed a yes/no exchange. Those remain separate tiny steps.

Before you move on

If the dot or हँ stalled, return only to its two-minute sign lesson before trying the complete dictation again.

Chapter 4

Paani: Hear Water, Then Write It Sign by Sign

Modes: ⇄ voice (2) ✍ pen (4) ⇄ Hands-free start: first 1 of 6 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can recognise, hear, say, read, and independently write पाणी as the Marwadi word for water.

A source-attested everyday noun secured by ear before three new signs are isolated, assembled, and retrieved independently in all four skills.

4.1 Hear *pāṇī* — meaning before spelling

Give the Chapter 3 four-skill response once: hear *hā(n) sā* and identify a respectful yes; say it; read हँ सा; then cover and write it. Say *ābhār* for formal thanks. Now set writing aside: today's new word begins with the ear and voice.

You'll want to know — one useful word

pāṇī — water

Listen for two long vowels: *pā-ṇī*. The middle sound is made with the tongue curled back a little. Hear the whole word twice, then say it once. Do not try to spell it yet; the next three tiny lessons will give the hand one piece at a time.

Your turn — meaning without letters

Imagine two cups: one holds water, one holds tea. Hear *pāṇī* and point to the water. Change the order and do it again. Then say *pāṇī* while imagining water.

Before you move on

Close the page. Say *pāṇī* once, then give its meaning.

Source: SIL International, *Marwari–English Dictionary* (2015).

4.2 प — *pa*, the first sign

Write हँ from memory, checking the first sign and the dot. With no new spelling in view, say the Marwadi word for water. Then write the familiar long-*ā* mark ा once.

Script — one new consonant

प — *pa*

Close the lips, release them without a strong puff, and say *pa*. Today the hand meets only प; the complete word stays hidden.

Writing — observe, trace, copy

1. look at प for three seconds
2. finger-trace its left stem, bowl, and headline
3. copy प twice
4. say *pa* after each copy

Before you move on

Hide the model for five seconds. Write प, then add ा to make पा.

4.3 ण — curled-back *ṇa*

Write हँ as one complete known word. Say *pāṇī* without looking at its spelling, then write ण from memory.

Script — one new consonant

𑖦 — *ṇa*

Curl the tongue tip slightly back for *ṇ*. Do not replace it with the dental *n* heard in the Hindi cognate. The Marwadi dictionary spelling in this chapter uses 𑖦, so the eye, voice, and hand keep that contrast clear from the beginning.

Writing — observe, trace, copy

1. look at 𑖦 for three seconds
2. finger-trace the lower loop, upright, and headline
3. copy 𑖦 twice
4. say *ṇa* after each copy

Before you move on

Cover both models. Write 𑖦, then 𑖦, with a clear space between them.

4.4 ी — the long-*ī* mark

Hear “Will you come?” and answer yes respectfully. Then say *pāṇī*. Write 𑖦, then 𑖦, from memory and name the curled-back sound.

Script — one new vowel mark

ी — long *ī*

Like familiar ी, this mark cannot stand alone in a word. It attaches to a consonant. Add it to 𑖦 and read 𑖦ी, *ṇī*.

Writing — attach only the mark

1. copy 𑖦 once
2. look at 𑖦ी
3. add ी on the right of your copy
4. compare the joined form, then say *ṇī*

Before you move on

Hide 𑖦ी for five seconds. Write it once, then uncover and compare.

4.5 पाणी — join the word you already know by ear

Write the first sign of राम from memory. Then say the Marwadi word for water and write पा, then णी, as two separate pieces. Check each piece before going on.

The exchange — two familiar pieces

पा + णी → पाणी — *pāṇī* — water

Join the pieces without adding or changing a sign. Keep ण, the curled-back sound that distinguishes this source-attested Marwadi spelling from its Hindi cognate.

The word, taken apart

The word belongs to an old Indo-Aryan family. Sanskrit *pānīya* meant something for drinking; related regional forms travelled through Middle Indo-Aryan into modern Marwadi पाणी. The history is a memory hook, not a new spelling task.

Writing — guided, then delayed

1. copy पाणी once while saying *pā-ṇī*
2. point to पा, then णी
3. hide the model for ten seconds
4. write the complete word from memory
5. uncover and compare प, ा, ण, and ी separately

Before you move on

Say पाणी once without looking, then write it once with the model covered.

Sources: SIL International, *Marwari-English Dictionary* (2015) and Turner, *A Comparative Dictionary of the Indo-Aryan Languages*, entry 8082.

4.6 Practice — hear, say, read, and write water

Give the older respectful yes in four quick steps: hear it and name its meaning; say it; read हॉ सा; then cover and write it. Now say the three meanings in English as you hear *ābhār*, *hā(n)* *sā*, and *pāṇī*. Write पा, then ण and ी separately from memory.

Your turn — four independent checks

1. **Listen:** hear *pāṇī* and identify water, without text. 2. **Speak:** see a picture or imagine a glass of water and say *pāṇī*, without notes. 3. **Read:** choose पाणी from आभार • हां • पाणी and give its meaning. 4. **Write:** hear *pāṇī*, wait fifteen seconds, then write पाणी with no model.

Score each line separately. Repeat only the missed line; strong speaking does not compensate for a missing ण or ी in writing.

What you've built — and what remains

You can retrieve one useful word in all four skills. You cannot yet request water in a complete Marwadi sentence; that needs pronouns, a request form, and register choices taught in later small steps.

Before you move on

If one sign stalled, return only to its two-minute sign lesson before repeating the complete dictation.

Chapter 5

Mharo Naam: Give One Name

Modes:  voice (6)  pen (4)  Hands-free start: first 1 of 10 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can hear, say, read, and independently write म्हारो नाम राम है, then substitute a chosen name in speech.

A source-attested name statement built by ear before four new signs are isolated and the complete line is retrieved from dictation.

5.1 Hear *mhāro* — one small word for “my”

Hear *pāṇī*, say **water**, say the Marwadi word back, then write its first sign प once. Set writing aside. The next chapter begins with the ear.

What to know first

mhāro — **my**, before a masculine singular noun

Listen twice: *mhā-ro*. Say it once. The breath after *m* belongs to the word; do not insert a full vowel between *m* and *h*. You do not need to spell it today.

Your turn

Point to yourself when you hear *mhāro*. Point away when you hear *pāṇī*. Change the order and do it once more.

Before you move on

Say *mhāro* once, then stop.

Sources: SIL International, *Marwari-English Dictionary* (2015) and Rajasthan Sahitya Akademi, *Jāgtī Jot*, November 2007.

5.2 ् — stop the built-in vowel

Write known म once, then read म as *ma*. Hear *mhāro* once. Today one tiny mark lets म close onto the next consonant without *a* between them.

Script

्

This is the **virāma**. Under म, it removes the built-in *a*: म् is *m*, not *ma*. Keep the model visible; no joined form is required yet.

Your turn

Finger-trace ् once beneath a printed म, then trace one pencil model. Say “vowel off” as your hand stops.

Before you move on

Cover the mark and draw it once beneath म.

5.3 ो — turn *ra* into *ro*

Write known सा once and point to ी in पाणी. Write र once, then draw yesterday’s vowel-off mark beneath a spare म. Today adds one sign to the right of र.

Script

र + ो → रो

Attached ो replaces the built-in *a*. Read रो as *ro*. It is one sign, even though it reaches above and to the right.

Your turn

Keep रो visible and copy it once. Point to र, then ो, and read *ro*.

Before you move on

Cover the model, wait three seconds, and write रो once.

5.4 म्हारो — the heard word becomes readable

Say the Marwadi word for **my** and recall what respectful सा does. From the heard cue *pāṇī*, write पाणी. Then write the vowel-off mark and रो from memory.

What to know first

म् + हा + रो → म्हारो — *mhāro* — my

Every piece is known. The virāma removes the vowel from म so म्ह begins *mh*, not *maha*.

Your turn

Look for five seconds, cover म्हारो, wait five seconds, then write it. Uncover and compare म्ह, ा, and रो separately. Repair only the piece that differs.

Before you move on

Read your repaired word once without romanization.

Sources: SIL International, *Marwari–English Dictionary* (2015) and Rajasthan Sahitya Akademi, *Jāgtī Jot*, November 2007.

5.5 Hear *nām* — name

Hear राम-राम सा and answer it. Retrieve पाणी once by ear, voice, eye, and writing. Then hear *mhāro*, say **my**, and read म्हारो once.

What to know first

nām — name

Listen twice, then say it once. Marwadi *nām*, Sanskrit *nāman*, and English *name* are distant members of the same old word family. That history is a memory hook; today's task is only sound and meaning.

Your turn

Touch your name on a card when you hear *nām*. Touch yourself when you hear *mhāro*. Change the order once.

Before you move on

Say *mhāro nām* and give the two-word meaning: **my name**.

Sources: SIL International, *Marwari-English Dictionary* (2015) and Turner, *A Comparative Dictionary of the Indo-Aryan Languages*.

5.6 न — a front-of-the-mouth *n*

Write independent न once. Say *nām* and its meaning. Read known ण with the tongue curled back. Today the tongue moves forward.

Script

न

Read न as *na*, with the tongue near the teeth. Do not replace it with retroflex ण from पाणी.

Your turn

Keep न visible. Finger-trace it once, then trace one pencil model. Point to न when you hear *na* and ण when you hear retroflex *ṇa*.

Before you move on

Cover the model and write न once.

5.7 नाम — name, with no new sign

Write known भ and the vowel-off mark ् once each. Say *nām* and its meaning, then write न once.

What to know first

न + ा + म → नाम — *nām* — name

Nothing new is hiding here: dental न, known long ा, and known म.

Your turn

Look for five seconds, cover नाम, wait five seconds, and write it once. Uncover, compare one piece at a time, and repair only a differing piece.

Before you move on

Read म्हारो नाम and say **my name**.

5.8 Hear *hai* — the small closing word

Read and write आभार once. Hear *mhāro* and *nām* in either order, then give each meaning.

What to know first

hai — is

Listen twice, then say it once. This tiny copula closes the name statement. Do not spell it yet; one vowel sign is still missing from your hand.

Your turn

Hear *mhāro nām rām hai*. Tap four beats: **my** | **name** | **Ram** | **is**. English changes the order in translation: **My name is Ram**.

Before you move on

Say the four-beat line once from sound: *mhāro nām rām hai*.

Sources: Ek Bharat Shreshtha Bharat language report and Rajasthan Sahitya Akademi, *Jāgti Jot*, November 2007.

5.9 ै — turn *ha* into *hai*

Say आभार for formal thanks. Say the closing word *hai*, then write known ह once.

Script

ह + ै → है

Attached ै replaces the built-in *a*. Read the whole word है as *hai*. Do not confuse ै with the taller े in रो.

Your turn

Keep है visible and copy it once. Point to ह, then ै, and read *hai*.

Before you move on

Cover the model, wait three seconds, and write है once.

5.10 म्हारो नाम राम है। — say one name

Hear *mhāro*, *nām*, *rām*, *hai* in mixed order. Give each meaning.

What to know first

म्हारो | नाम | राम | है।

>

mhāro nām rām hai — My name is Ram.

The written line adds no new sign. है is known ह plus ै. Replace राम with your chosen name when speaking; keep Ram for the first writing attempt because every sign is already yours.

Your turn

1. hear the line and point to the person naming themselves
2. say the line once with *rām*
3. read the four groups without romanization

Before you move on

Cover every written model. Hear the line once and write it. Then uncover and repair one group, not the whole sentence.

Sources: Ek Bharat Shreshtha Bharat language report and Rajasthan Sahitya Akademi, *Jāgtī Jot*, November 2007.

Chapter 6

Tharo Naam: Ask One Name

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) ✍️ pen (3) 🗣️ Hands-free start: first 1 of 8 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can ask थारो नाम काँई है and answer with a chosen name in four separately scored skills.

The question half of the name exchange, built by ear before three new signs are isolated and joined to the already-secure answer.

6.1 Hear *thāro* — turn from my to your

Say *mhāro nām rām hai* once. Write न, then है, from memory. Point to yourself on *mhāro*.

What to know first

thāro — **your**, before a masculine singular noun

Listen twice: *thā-ro*. Let a small breath follow *t*. Point to another person when you hear it. Spelling waits for the next lesson.

Your turn

Hear *mhāro* and point to yourself. Hear *thāro* and point gently away. Change the order twice.

Before you move on

Say the pair once: *mhāro* — my; *thāro* — your.

Sources: SIL International, *Marwari-English Dictionary* (2015) and Ek Bharat Shreshtha Bharat language report.

6.2 थ — one breathed consonant

Read हॉ, say **yes**, then hear *thāro*, point away, and say **your**.

Script

थ

Read थ as *tha*: the tongue begins near the teeth and a small breath follows. It is one new shape. The remaining signs in *thāro* are already known.

Your turn

Keep थ visible. Finger-trace it once, then trace one printed model once. Say *tha* after your hand stops.

Before you move on

Cover the model and write थ once.

6.3 थारो — your

Say *thāro* and its meaning. Read म्हारो and give the opposite direction: my.

What to know first

थ + ा + रो → थारो — *thāro* — your

Only थ was new. The rest comes from राम and म्हारो.

Your turn

Look for five seconds, cover थारो, wait five seconds, then write it. Uncover and compare थ, ा, and रो separately.

Before you move on

Read the two words once without romanization.

6.4 Hear *kāĩ* — what

Retrieve हाँ सा once by ear, voice, eye, and writing; point to ै in है. Then read थारो, hear *thāro nām*, and give its meaning: **your name**.

What to know first

kāĩ — what

Listen for one long, lightly nasal middle and a final long *ĩ*. Say the whole word once rather than exaggerating the nasal sound. Its old interrogative root belongs to the same deep family as Sanskrit *kim* and English *what*.

Your turn

Hear *thāro nām kāĩ hai?* Point to the question mark and say **What is your name?** No spelling yet.

Before you move on

Say the four-beat question once from sound.

Sources: SIL International, *Marwari-English Dictionary* (2015), Turner, *A Comparative Dictionary of the Indo-Aryan Languages*, and Rajasthan Sahitya Akademi, *Jāgtĩ Jot*, September 1999.

6.5 क — the first sign in *kāĩ*

Hear *kāĩ* and say **what**.

Script

क

Read क as *ka*. Keep the sound short and unaspirated. Only this one shape is new today.

Your turn

Keep क visible. Finger-trace it once, then trace one printed model once. Say *ka* after your hand stops.

Before you move on

Cover the model and write क once.

6.6 ई — long $\bar{i}$ standing alone

Write ष, then क, once each. Point to attached ी in पाणी and say its long vowel.

Script

ई

Read ई as long $\bar{i}$. Use this independent form when the vowel stands on its own. Attached ी still belongs after a consonant.

Your turn

Keep ई visible and copy it once. Then point: ई stands alone; ी attaches.

Before you move on

Cover the model, wait three seconds, and write ई once.

6.7 कांई — what, with no new sign

Write known ण and new थ once each. Say *kāĩ* and its meaning, then write क and independent ई. Point to the known nasal dot in हां.

What to know first

क + ा + ं + ई → कांई — *kāĩ* — what

No shape is new. Read the whole word smoothly; the dot lightly nasalizes the long middle rather than creating an extra beat.

Your turn

Look for five seconds, cover कांई, wait five seconds, and write it. Uncover and compare क, ा, ं, and ई separately.

Before you move on

Read थारो नाम कांई है? once without romanization.

6.8 Practice — ask one name and give one name

Say the four older meanings as you hear *rām-rām sā*, *ābhār*, *hā(n) sā*, and *pāñī*. Write only पाणी from the last cue.

What to know first

थारो नाम कांई है?

>

म्हारो नाम राम है।

The question asks **What is your name?** The answer says **My name is Ram.** In speech, replace *rām* with the name the speaker chooses. This book teaches one documented central-Marwari form; regional speakers may use another possessive or copula, and that variation is not an error.

Your turn

1. **Listen:** hear one of the two lines and identify question or answer. 2. **Speak:** hear the question and answer with a chosen name, without notes. 3. **Read:** match the printed question to the printed answer. 4. **Write:** hear the question, wait ten seconds, and write it with no model.

Score each line separately. Speaking cannot cover a missing word in writing; reading cannot cover an unanswered spoken question.

Before you move on

Stop after one complete exchange. Accuracy comes before speed.
Sources: Ek Bharat Shreshtha Bharat language report, SIL International, *Marwari–English Dictionary* (2015), and Rajasthan Sahitya Akademi, *Jāgtī Jot*, September 1999.

Pronunciation & Writing Reference

This is a lookup page, never a prerequisite gate.

The sounds in Chapter 1

- **r** in *rām* is a brief tongue-tip tap, not the English bunched or retroflex *r*. Say a quick Spanish-style single *r* if that is familiar.
- **ā** is a steady open vowel held longer than short *a*. The macron in transliteration marks length; Devanagari writes it with ा after a consonant.
- **m** and **s** are close to English *m* and *s*.

The writing rule you need first

Devanagari consonants carry a built-in short *a*. Thus र is *ra* and स is *sa*. The right-side mark ा changes that vowel to long *ā*: रा *rā*, सा *sā*. The chapter teaches only those signs and combines them as राम-राम सा.

The lessons ask learners to copy visible forms before they claim a stroke order. Handwriting conventions vary across schools, so a directional stroke sequence will be added only with a specific source. For Marwari-specific Devanagari history and characters, see the Unicode proposal on Devanagari letters for Marwari.

Glossary

This glossary collects every word and phrase taught in the book. Pronunciation appears when it differs from the written form; chapter numbers show where each entry is introduced.

आभार *ābhār*

formal thanks; gratitude

Introduced in Chapter 2.

हां सा *hā(n) sā*

yes, respectfully

Introduced in Chapter 3.

काई *kāī*

what, assembled from one consonant and familiar vowel material

Introduced in Chapter 6.

म्हारो *mhāro*

my, now heard and read

Introduced in Chapter 5.

म्हारो नाम राम है। *mhāro nām rām hai*

My name is Ram.

Introduced in Chapter 5.

नाम *nām*

name, assembled from known signs

Introduced in Chapter 5.

राम *rām*

Ram, the name repeated in the greeting राम-राम सा, built and written from र + ा + म

Introduced in Chapter 1.

राम-राम सा *rām-rām sā*

a respectful Marwadi greeting

Introduced in Chapter 1.

थारो *thāro*

your, assembled from one new and three known signs

Introduced in Chapter 6.

Review Questions

Try these without looking ahead. Every prompt comes from the same canonical lesson data as its chapter. Answers begin in the next section.

Chapter 1

1.1 र — *one sign, and the beginning of a greeting*

What sound does र carry?

1.2 ा — *make ra into rā*

What does ा do to the built-in vowel of a consonant?

1.3 राम — *your first whole written word*

Build and name the written word rām from its three visible pieces.

1.4 स — *a second consonant*

Which sign is sa: र or स?

1.5 सा — *reuse a mark instead of learning a new rule*

Write sā by adding the long-vowel mark to स.

1.6 राम-राम सा — *your first complete Marwadi greeting*

Give the respectful Marwadi greeting taught in this lesson.

1.7 Practice — *hear it, answer it, write it*

You hear rām-rām sā. Write the respectful reply from memory.

Chapter 2

2.1 आ — *long ā at the beginning*

Which sign writes long ā at the beginning of a word?

2.2 भ — *bha, with a small breath*

Read the new sign भ and name its sound.

2.3 आभार — *formal thanks, built from known signs*

Build the formal Marwadi/Rajasthani word for thanks from आ + भ + ा + र.

2.4 Practice — *receive a kindness, offer formal thanks*

You receive formal help. Write the one-word thanks response from memory.

Chapter 3**3.1 ह** — *ha, one new sign*

Read the one new sign ह and name its sound.

3.2 ः — *a small dot for the nasal ending*

Which small mark completes the attested spelling हं?

3.3 हां सा — *a respectful yes*

Write the respectful Marwadi yes from ह + ा + ः, followed by the respect word सा.

3.4 Listen and answer — *yes without the page*

You hear hā(n) sā. What social move did the speaker make?

3.5 Practice — *hear a yes, give a yes*

From the spoken cue hā(n) sā alone, write the respectful affirmative.

Chapter 4**4.1 Hear pāṇī** — *meaning before spelling*

You hear pāṇī with no written cue. What does it mean?

4.2 प — *pa, the first sign*

Write pa, then add the familiar long-ā mark to make pā.

4.3 ण — *curled-back ṇa*

Write the sign that carries the curled-back ṇ sound in this Marwadi word.

4.4 ी — *the long-ī mark*

Add the long-ī mark to ण and write the result.

4.5 पाणी — *join the word you already know by ear*

Join पा and णी, then give the word's meaning.

4.6 Practice — *hear, say, read, and write water*

From the spoken cue pāṇī alone, write the Marwadi word and give its meaning.

Chapter 5

5.1 Hear mhāro — one small word for “my”

You hear mhāro with no text. What small English word does it supply before a masculine noun?

5.2 ् — stop the built-in vowel

What does ् do under म्?

5.3 ो — turn ra into ro

Add the visible o sign to र and read the result.

5.4 म्हारी — the heard word becomes readable

After hiding the model, write mhāro and give its meaning.

5.5 Hear nām — name

You hear nām. What does it mean?

5.6 न — a front-of-the-mouth n

Write the sign that begins nām, name.

5.7 नाम — name, with no new sign

After hiding the model, write nām and give its meaning.

5.8 Hear hai — the small closing word

What job does heard hai do at the end of the name statement?

5.9 ै — turn ha into hai

Add the new sign to ह and read the result.

5.10 म्हारी नाम राम है। — say one name

From the heard cue mhāro nām rām hai alone, write the complete Marwadi statement.

Chapter 6

6.1 Hear thāro — turn from my to your

You hear thāro. Does it point to my or your?

6.2 थ — one breathed consonant

Read the one new sign थ.

6.3 थारो — your

Write the pair for my and your in that order.

6.4 Hear kāī — what

You hear kāī in a question. What does it ask for?

6.5 क — the first sign in kāī

Read the one new sign क.

6.6 ई — *long ī standing alone*

Write the long ī sign that can stand alone.

6.7 काई — *what, with no new sign*

After hiding the model, write kāī and give its meaning.

6.8 Practice — *ask one name and give one name*

From sound alone, write the Marwadi question What is your name?, then answer aloud with a chosen name.

Answer Key

The first response is the canonical display answer. When a question accepts other authored forms, they appear underneath.

Chapter 1

1.1 र — *one sign, and the beginning of a greeting*

Answer: रा

Also accepted: र a; र

1.2 ा — *make ra into rā*

Answer: It changes short a to long ā.

Also accepted: makes it aa; lengthens a; long a

1.3 राम — *your first whole written word*

Answer: राम — Ram

Also accepted: राम; र + ा + म; रा + म

1.4 स — *a second consonant*

Answer: स

Also accepted: the second sign; sa is स

1.5 सा — *reuse a mark instead of learning a new rule*

Answer: सा

Also accepted: स + ा; saa

1.6 राम-राम सा — *your first complete Marwadi greeting*

Answer: राम-राम सा

Also accepted: राम राम सा; rām-rām sā; ram-ram sa

1.7 Practice — *hear it, answer it, write it*

Answer: राम-राम सा

Also accepted: राम राम सा; rām-rām sā; ram-ram sa

Chapter 2

2.1 आ — *long ā at the beginning*

Answer: आ

Also accepted: aa independent; independent aa

2.2 भ — bha, *with a small breath*

Answer: bha

Also accepted: भ

2.3 आभार — *formal thanks, built from known signs*

Answer: आभार — formal thanks

Also accepted: आभार; aabhaar; ābhār

2.4 Practice — *receive a kindness, offer formal thanks*

Answer: आभार

Also accepted: ābhār; aabhaar

Chapter 3

3.1 ह — ha, *one new sign*

Answer: ha

Also accepted: ह

3.2 ः — *a small dot for the nasal ending*

Answer: ः

Also accepted: anusvara; dot above; nasal mark

3.3 हाँ सा — *a respectful yes*

Answer: हाँ सा

Also accepted: हाँ सा!; haan sa; hā(n) sā

3.4 Listen and answer — *yes without the page*

Answer: They answered yes respectfully.

Also accepted: respectful yes; yes politely; yes

3.5 Practice — *hear a yes, give a yes*

Answer: हाँ सा

Also accepted: हाँ सा!; haan sa; hā(n) sā

Chapter 4

4.1 Hear pāṇī — *meaning before spelling*

Answer: water

Also accepted: drinking water

4.2 प — pa, *the first sign*

Answer: प

Also accepted: प + ः; paa; pā

4.3 ण — *curled-back ṇa*

Answer: ण

Also accepted: nna; retroflex n

4.4 ी — *the long-ī mark*

Answer: णी

Also accepted: ण + ी; nnee; ṇī

4.5 पाणी — *join the word you already know by ear*

Answer: पाणी — water

Also accepted: पाणी; paani — water; pāṇī — water

4.6 Practice — *hear, say, read, and write water*

Answer: पाणी — water

Also accepted: पाणी; पाणी water; pāṇī — water

Chapter 5

5.1 Hear mhāro — *one small word for “my”*

Answer: my

Also accepted: mine

5.2 ् — *stop the built-in vowel*

Answer: It removes the built-in a, making m rather than ma.

Also accepted: removes a; vowel off; m not ma

5.3 ो — *turn ra into ro*

Answer: रो — ro

Also accepted: री; ro

5.4 म्हारो — *the heard word becomes readable*

Answer: म्हारो — my

Also accepted: म्हारो; mhāro — my

5.5 Hear nām — *name*

Answer: name

5.6 न — *a front-of-the-mouth n*

Answer: न

5.7 नाम — *name, with no new sign*

Answer: नाम — name

Also accepted: नाम; nām — name

5.8 Hear hai — *the small closing word*

Answer: It means is and closes the statement.

Also accepted: is; copula

5.9 ै — *turn ha into hai*

Answer: है — hai

Also accepted: है; hai

5.10 म्हारो नाम राम है। — *say one name*

Answer: म्हारो नाम राम है।

Also accepted: म्हारो नाम राम है

Chapter 6

6.1 *Hear thāro — turn from my to your*

Answer: your

6.2 थ — *one breathed consonant*

Answer: tha

Also accepted: थ

6.3 थारो — *your*

Answer: म्हारो — my; थारो — your

Also accepted: म्हारो थारो

6.4 *Hear kāĩ — what*

Answer: what

6.5 क — *the first sign in kāĩ*

Answer: ka

Also accepted: क

6.6 ई — *long ī standing alone*

Answer: ई

6.7 काई — *what, with no new sign*

Answer: काई — what

Also accepted: काई; kāĩ — what

6.8 *Practice — ask one name and give one name*

Answer: थारो नाम काई है? — म्हारो नाम [name] है।

Also accepted: थारो नाम काई है; thāro nām kāĩ hai

Sources for this starter edition

The opening exchange is attested in Rajasthan Sahitya Akademi's *Jāgtī Jot*, August–September 2018. Its April 2004 issue uses आभार while expressing gratitude in Rajasthani prose. Rajasthan Foundation's official language page places Marwari among the major forms of Rajasthani. The lesson files carry the direct links. Chapters 1 and 2 are generated from those canonical files. Chapter 3 adds a scholarly Marwari text edition that identifies *hā(n)-sā* as the polite affirmative and an April–May 2019 *Jāgtī Jot* dialogue that uses हाँ सा in context. Chapter 4 uses SIL International's 2015 *Marwari–English Dictionary* for पाणी, “water,” and Turner's comparative dictionary for its Indo-Aryan history. Chapters 5 and 6 use the Ek Bharat Shreshtha Bharat language report for the exact name-question and name-answer pair, cross-checked against SIL's dictionary and Rajasthan Sahitya Akademi prose for the component forms.

Index

Look up an English meaning, a dedicated language topic, or a chapter topic. Each linked reference opens the chapter where the material is introduced; the focus labels name only explicitly typed lesson sections.

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a respectful Marwadi greeting राम-राम सा (rām-rām sā)

Chapter 1, p. 1

◌ं — **a small dot for the nasal ending**

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 3, p. 11

Aabhaar: Formal Thanks, Two New Signs

chapter topic; Chapter 2, p. 7

F

formal thanks; gratitude आभार (ābhār)

explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 2, p. 7

H

Haan Sa: A Respectful Yes, Sign by Sign

chapter topic; Chapter 3, p. 11

M

◌ी — **make *ra* into *rā***

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 1, p. 1

Mharo Naam: Give One Name

chapter topic; Chapter 5, p. 21

My name is Ram. म्हारो नाम राम है। (mhāro nām rām hai)

Chapter 5, p. 21

my, now heard and read म्हारो (mhāro)

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N

name, assembled from known signs नाम (nām)

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P

Paani: Hear Water, Then Write It Sign by Sign

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R

Ram-Ram Sa: A Greeting the Hand Can Make

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Ram, the name repeated in the greeting राम-राम सा, built and written from र + ा + म राम (rām)

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S

् — **stop the built-in vowel**

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 5, p. 21

T

Tharo Naam: Ask One Name

chapter topic; Chapter 6, p. 29

ी — **the long-ī mark**

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 4, p. 15

ै — **turn *ha* into *hai***

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 5, p. 21

ो — **turn *ra* into *ro***

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 5, p. 21

W

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Y

yes, respectfully हाँ सा (hā(n) sā)

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Other

आ — long ā at the beginning

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 2, p. 7

ई — long ī standing alone

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 6, p. 29

क — the first sign in kāī

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 6, p. 29

ण — curled-back ṇa

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 4, p. 15

थ — one breathed consonant

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 6, p. 29

न — a front-of-the-mouth n

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 5, p. 21

प — pa, the first sign

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 4, p. 15

भ — bha, with a small breath

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 2, p. 7

र — one sign, and the beginning of a greeting

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 1, p. 1

स — a second consonant

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 1, p. 1

सा — reuse a mark instead of learning a new rule

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 1, p. 1

ह — ha, one new sign

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 3, p. 11